

■ ■ Pakistan vs India ■ ■

Summary Scorecard — Rice Export to Democratic Republic of Congo (DRC)

Factor	■ ■ Pakistan	■ ■ India
Transit Time Karachi / Mumbai → Matadi	32–37 days ■ FASTEST	45–50 days ■ 13 days slower
Rice Export Reliability (government bans)	Never banned exports ■ STABLE	Banned 2023–2024 ■ 14-month disruption
EU Food Safety Alerts (pesticide residues, 2024)	74 alerts ■ LOW RISK	264 alerts ■ 3.6× more than Pakistan
EU Non-Basmati Rejections (2024)	2 rejections ■ EXCELLENT	37 rejections ■ 18× more than Pakistan
Price (5% broken white) FOB per MT	~\$445/MT ■ Competitive	~\$400–430/MT ■ ■ Slightly cheaper
Basmati Quality (Super Basmati, 1121)	World-class EU market growing +15% ■ PREMIUM	Good — but declining EU trust ■ ■ Under pressure
Diplomatic Goodwill in DRC	MONUSCO peacekeeping 20+ years ■ STRONG	Moderate —
Supply Diversification for DRC Buyer	Safe backup source ■ REDUCES RISK	Single-source risk ■ 2023 proved it
OVERALL VERDICT	WIN on reliability, safety & speed	Price edge only (short-term)

13 Days	3.6×	18×	\$445/MT
Faster delivery than India	Fewer EU food safety alerts	Fewer EU rejections	Competitive FOB price (5% broken)

Key Pitch Points for a DRC Buyer Already Buying from India

1	Supply Reliability	India banned rice exports in 2023 for 14 months without warning. Pakistan has NEVER banned exports. Use Pakistan as your secure backup supplier.
2	Food Safety	Pakistan had only 74 EU food safety alerts vs 264 for India in 2024. Pakistani rice is safer for your customers and their families.

3	Faster Delivery	Karachi to Matadi is 32–37 days. Mumbai to Matadi is 45–50 days. You get your rice 2 weeks earlier — less port time, less spoilage, lower costs.
4	Trial With Zero Risk	Request 1–2 containers as a trial. Pay 30% advance + 70% on Bill of Lading. Free sample bag available before commitment.
5	Diplomatic Trust	Pakistan has served in UN MONUSCO peacekeeping in DRC for 20+ years. We are a long-term partner, not just a seller.

■ **Pakistan CAN WIN — on Reliability, Food Safety, Speed & Diplomatic Trust. India's only edge is a small price difference — easily offset by lower spoilage, faster delivery, and zero supply-ban risk.**

Sources: ProPakistani · S&P; Global · Al Jazeera · Agri-Food Update · IFPRI · FW Freight · Concave Agri · TDAP